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Joseph Barnby

(1838-96)

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The radiant sun, declining

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1 The radiant sun, declining,
Will soon have pass'd away,
And silver stars outshining
Make but as transient stay;
O Light! all light excelling,
When sun or stars decline,
Shine forth, our gloom dispelling
With light and joy divine.

2 Like sunbeams, quickly flying
Before the dusky night,
Or stars' fair lustre, dying
With morning's clearer light,
So, swift beyond our measure,
Life's little day speeds on;
A moment's fleeting pleasure
And light and life are gone.

3 Thou, who in human fashion
Didst render up Thy breath,
And by Thy bitter Passion
Destroy the sting of death;
When life's brief day is over
Its toil, its care and sin
Open Thine arms of mercy,
And take the weary in.

4 O Saviour, be Thou near us
Till all our toil is o'er,
Till heavenly light shall cheer us,
And night return no more.
So, to the life immortal,
With joy well haste away
And pass thro' death's dark portal
To never-ending day.

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